



Looking for Musk

GAUTAM ADANI'S ASTRONOMICAL rise continues. With the largest cement sector deal with ACC and Ambuja closed, he is the first Asian to become the second-richest person on the planet. Adani, with a net worth of \$150 billion (as of September 21, 2022), is ahead of Amazon Founder Jeff Bezos (\$147 billion) and only trailing Tesla chief Elon Musk (\$268 billion) per Bloomberg Billionaires Index. Meanwhile, Adani has picked his eldest son **Karan Adani** (right) to lead ACC, while he helms Ambuja; but his stake in both the firms are pledged to the hilt.

—ARNAB DUTTA



PURI'S PLAINSPEAK

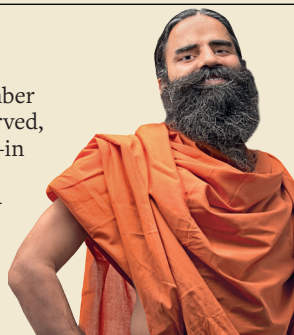
AFTER MONTHS OF speculation over BPCL's disinvestment, Hardeep Singh Puri, Union Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas, has said that the proposal is off the table, as the country's second-largest oil refining and fuel retailing firm had received only a limited number of bids. The government, which controls a 52.98 per cent stake in BPCL, is expected to revive the process once the outlook for the oil & gas sector improves.

—MANISH PANT

ASPIRATIONAL BABA

Yoga guru Baba Ramdev-backed Patanjali group on September 16 announced that it will launch four new IPOs—Patanjali Ayurved, Patanjali Wellness, Patanjali Medicine and Patanjali Lifestyle—in the next five years. At present, only Patanjali Foods is listed on the exchanges. The company said it is “working to achieve a target of ₹5 lakh-crore m-cap for these five firms”, and a turnover of ₹1 lakh crore for the group in the next five-seven years.

—RAHUL OBEROI



Goodbye GOAT



The world of tennis is a lot poorer after **Roger Federer**, 41, bid adieu to the game. If the fans are inconsolable, brands are also staring at a void as he has been the face of names like Rolex, Nike and Mercedes-Benz, to name a few. In 2018, Uniqlo had signed a \$300-million deal to become his kit sponsor. Now, that will be a hard one to ace.

—KRISHNA GOPALAN

CHANGE ELEMENT



Sebi chief Madhabi Puri Buch wants the markets regulator to be “developmental and facilitative” in its approach. She has tasked select Sebi staffers to engage directly with market participants to get their views to formulate better policies for the market. “So, if any of you have been receiving calls from these individuals saying *batao kya karna hai* (tell us what to do), it's because suddenly they need to deliver...” she said at a market seminar.

—ASHISH RUKHAIYAR

Leading the Charge

AFTER YEARS OF deliberation, the Vedanta Group has chosen Gujarat over Maharashtra for its semiconductor plant, to be developed in a joint venture with Taiwan's Foxconn. However, in this battle of the states to host Vedanta, Chairman **Anil Agarwal** has tried to settle Maharashtra's ruffled feathers by intending to bring significant investments into the state during the development of the pan-India semiconductor ecosystem that he plans to set up. Chip thrills all the way!

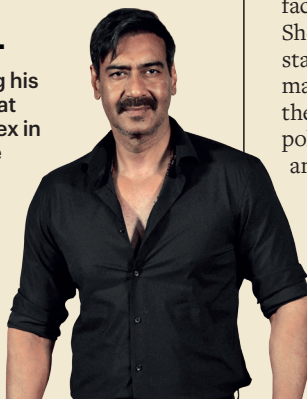
—NIDHI SINGAL



ON THE PROWL

Actor Ajay Devgn is expanding his NY Cinemas' footprint in Gujarat with a new four-screen multiplex in Ahmedabad. This comes in the backdrop of multiplex players realising the potential of smaller cities, especially after Hindi-dubbed versions of south Indian films revealed the untapped opportunity in India's hinterlands.

—VIDYA S.



KARAN ADANI PHOTO BY NANDAN DAVE; BABA RAMDEV PHOTO BY BANDEEP SINGH